

Retention Playbook P5 - Low-Engagement Activation & Discovery

When this applies

This playbook targets subscribers who are still active but thinly engaged: low `active_days_30` (few distinct days used in the last month), low `secs_30` (low total listening volume), and/or low `unq_30` (a narrow range of unique tracks - the subscriber is replaying a small, unchanging set rather than exploring the catalog). This is distinct from dormancy (Playbook P4): the account is genuinely in use, but the engagement is thin enough that it is at risk of tipping into dormancy.

A narrowing `unq_30` in particular signals a subscriber settling into a small comfort zone of tracks, which frequently precedes a drop in `active_days_30` the following month as the experience becomes repetitive.

Recommended interventions

For low `active_days_30` / low `secs_30`: build a listening habit rather than pushing a single large content recommendation. A short daily or every-other-day "quick pick" notification at a consistent time of day (matched to the subscriber's historical listening hours where available) is more effective at growing `active_days_30` than an infrequent large content drop, because it targets the frequency metric directly.

For low `unq_30` (narrow catalog use): the intervention is discovery-oriented rather than frequency-oriented. Surface adjacent artists and playlists near the subscriber's existing comfort zone rather than a completely novel genre - a large jump in recommended content away from established preferences is more likely to be ignored than a moderate expansion just beyond it.

These two branches (frequency vs. discovery) should not be bundled into a single generic "use the app more" message - a subscriber who listens narrowly but daily needs catalog discovery, while a subscriber who listens broadly but rarely needs a frequency nudge, and sending the wrong one wastes the contact.